

Presenting Your Best Self

With Catherine Thorburn

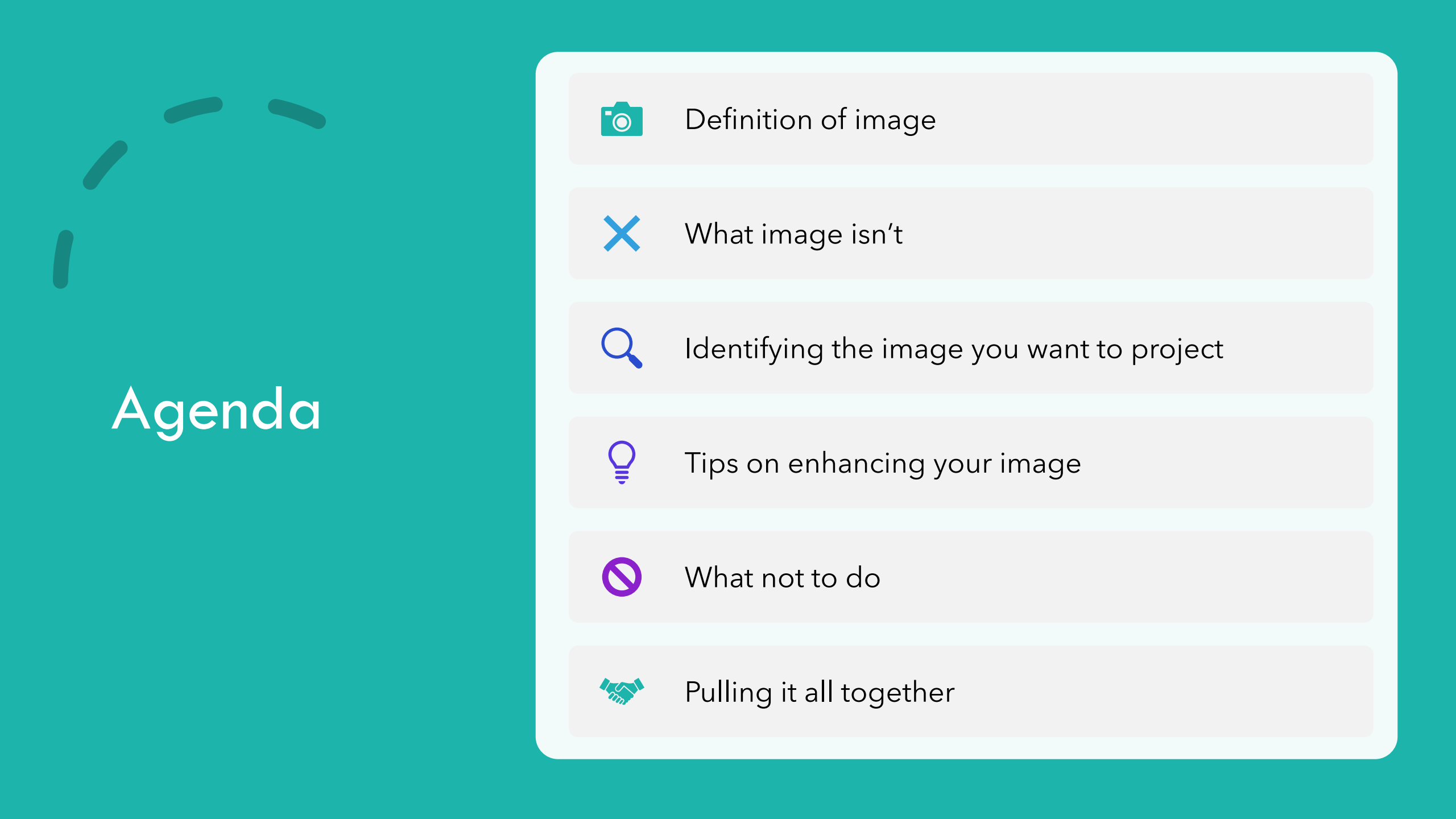


FELDMANDAXON
PARTNERS INC.

Me

Catherine Thorburn
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Agenda



Definition of image



What image isn't



Identifying the image you want to project



Tips on enhancing your image



What not to do



Pulling it all together

Your Image is a
Total Package



What Do
These Images
Say?



Image Speaks

Your confidence and
total package



The confidence others
have in you



Polishing the Total Package

Polishing the total package of your image is about **ENHANCING** who you are, **not** about **changing** who you are.



Polishing the Total Package

Again, it's about **ENHANCING** who you are.



Before and After



The Complete Package of Your Image is Made of:



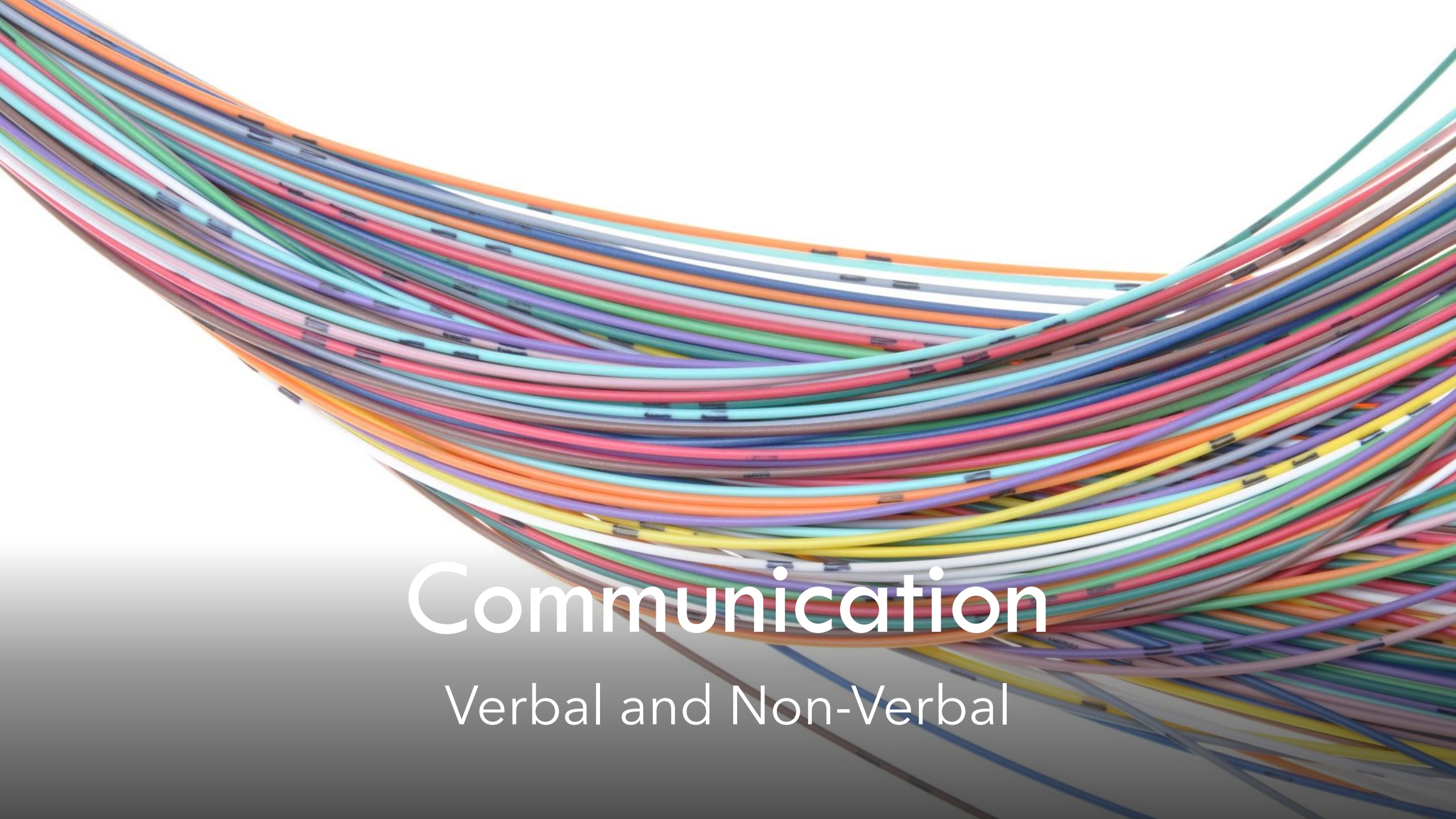
Communication
(verbal, non-verbal)



Behaviour
(what you do,
etiquette)



Appearance
(clothes, accessories,
grooming)

A large, dense bundle of multi-colored cables or wires, curving across the frame, symbolizing communication. The cables are in various colors including red, blue, green, yellow, orange, and purple, and are arranged in a way that suggests a complex network or data flow.

Communication

Verbal and Non-Verbal

Avoid the Ums
and Ahs

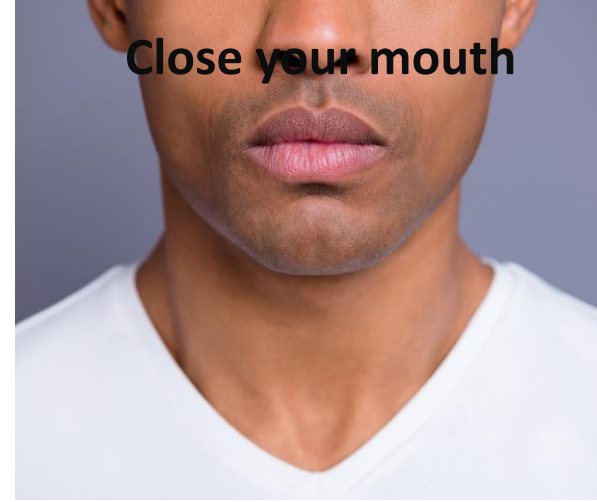


How to Avoid the Ums and Ahs

Tell a story



Close your mouth



**Practice speaking with
someone**



**Rehearse, rehearse,
rehearse**



What You Say is Important

So too is how you say it.



Avoid speaking too quickly.

If you speak too quickly, the interviewer may miss some things you have to say. You might only get one chance!



Speak clearly and loudly enough to be heard.

Avoid having your hand over your mouth or muffling your speech. You want to be heard!



Use simple sentences.

Avoid using jargon. You want to be understood!



Keep them interested.

Use animations. Use different tones to express yourself. Pause from time to time.



The First Impression

It provides the interviewer with a snapshot of who you are. Make it memorable and positive!

- Tilt your head slightly.
- Smile!
- Make eye contact.
- Make the first move. Extend your hand first. Be firm but sensitive. Don't crush hands and be cautious of the recipient wearing rings.
- Try to remember names. If you forget, start by saying your name first.
- Look at business cards and keep them visible.

Use Body Language to Compliment Dialogue



Use non-verbal cues to emphasize what you are saying. You may use your hands, facial expressions, and overall positioning appropriately.



Nod and tilt your head. Try not to look stiff, as this can be perceived as unapproachable and/or nervous. Nodding indicates you are listening.



Pay attention to your facial expressions. Avoid looking disgruntled or confused. Try not to roll your eyes.

Use Body Language to Compliment Dialogue



Respect other's space.



Watch what you do with your hands.



Pay attention to how you stand.



Be Conscious of What Your Body Language is Articulating to Others

- Sit at an angle that makes the interviewer feel important. Lean forward slightly. Avoid leaning back and looking too relaxed.
- Open your arms when sitting. Avoid crossing your arms. Using your hands while talking can be both expressive AND distracting.
- Keep your hands visible at all times. Keep your hands above the table/desk. Avoid putting your hands in your pockets.



Body Language Suggestions

Joe Navarro, a non-verbal communications expert, suggests:

- Any time you touch your neck, something is bothering you.
- Nervous ticks project a loss of power.





Behaviour

Meet and Greet Etiquette

Proper Etiquette

Displaying proper etiquette builds off the first impression and tells a story about you.



Send an old-fashioned thank-you note. Your personal note will stand out from the email clutter. Be sure to include your contact info so they know who the courteous candidate was.



Avoid emailing outside business hours. Respect others' time. Be mindful of maintaining clear professional boundaries.



Be mindful of your environment. Turn off phones/devices during an interview. Try not to be texting, emailing, talking on phone while waiting.



Be polite. Say thank you! Men: chivalry ISN'T dead!

Show Respect



Listen attentively. Pay attention to the speaker and what she/he has to say.



Acknowledge others and be inclusive. Focus on everyone and not just one individual.



Respect others' time. Avoid rambling and going over your allotted interview time.



Be clear and concise when leaving a voicemail. Keep it short and be clear when indicating why you are calling.



Leave your name and phone number; speak clearly and slowly. Repeat your contact information.

Drop Bad Habits

Pay attention to what your hands are doing!



Smile!

Who would you like to hire?



?





Appearance

Clothes, Accessories, and Grooming

Colour Psychology

Colours unconsciously speak for your personality:

- When interviewing for a conservative office job, opt for white.
- For a youthful impression, wear green. It implies freshness and vitality.
- Wearing lighter-coloured clothing close to your face helps others focus on your face and what you are saying.
- When in doubt, match your shirt with your eye colour.
- Lighter clothing makes you look more approachable.



Tips for Men

An up-to-date wardrobe is vital to portraying current and modern:

- **Keep your suits up-to-date.** If your suits are more than 5 years old, consider investing in a new one as styles change over time.
- **Don't date yourself with your tie.** Ensure length, width, patterns are on point with current trends. You should always wear a tie, unless you are applying at a very casual company.
- **Always use a belt that is the correct size and form-flattering.** If you have gained/lost weight over the years, invest in a belt that fits you properly.



Tips for Women

Dressing on the side of conservative allows the interviewer to focus on you:

- **Avoid wearing a sleeveless blouse.** If you choose to go without sleeves, pair it with a blazer or cardigan.
- **Keep your skirt at knee length.** Try sitting down to gauge appropriate length. Short skirts may bring unwanted attention.
- **Pair a skirt with panty hose/nylons/tights.** Showing less skin is more appropriate in most office environments.



Accessories

Your contemporary style and magnetism can be achieved with unique yet subtle accessories.

**Avoid loud or
distracting shoes**



**Keep your eyeglasses
on trend**



**Add flair with a
necklace, bag, blouse**



**Add colour with a tie,
shirt, pocket square**



Investing in Attire

To achieve your desired image, keep these points in mind when investing in interview attire:



Have at least 2-3 suits. You may be invited to follow-up interviews; avoid wearing the same suit every time.



Avoid garments that crease easily. Creases make you look disheveled and like you didn't take the time to iron/press your outfit.

Investing in Attire on a Budget

If you're on a limited budget, investing in just a few of these items will spice up your ensemble.



Common Situations to Avoid

When putting together your interview attire, try to avoid this “sticky” situation:

Awkward Scenario



A Solution



Common Situations to Avoid

When preparing to make your first impression, try not to leave a lingering scent.

Your Norm



Awkward Scenario



A Solution



Winter Dressing

Compliment your attire appropriately during awkward winter months:

- Wear winter accessories that compliment your interview attire.
- If you need to wear boots on a snowy day, give yourself enough time to change into appropriate shoes, and bring a bag to stash your boots.



Remember

First impressions count!

COMMON NONVERBAL MISTAKES MADE DURING JOB INTERVIEWS

67%



Fail to make eye contact

47%



Have little knowledge of the company

38%



Don't smile

33%



Have bad posture

33%



Fidget too much

26%



Have a weak handshake

21%



Play with their hair or touch their face

21%



Cross their arms over their chest

9%



Use too many hand gestures



In a survey of more than 2,000 hiring managers, 33% claimed to know whether or not they would hire someone within 90 seconds.

STATISTICS SHOW THAT FIRST IMPRESSIONS ARE DETERMINED BY:

55%



The way you dress, act, and walk through the door

38%



The quality of your voice, grammar, and confidence

7%



The words you choose to say

THINGS THAT HAVE AN IMPACT ON FIRST IMPRESSIONS

70%

of employers claim they don't want applicants to be **overly fashionable** or **trendy**

65%

of hiring managers say clothes can be the **deciding factor** between two similar candidates

BRIGHTLY-COLORED CLOTHING IS BAD



Be Memorable in a Positive Way

- Be remembered for you, **NOT** your grooming habits.
- Grooming your eyebrows, hair, and nails will give you a **polished** look and help you avoid visual distraction.

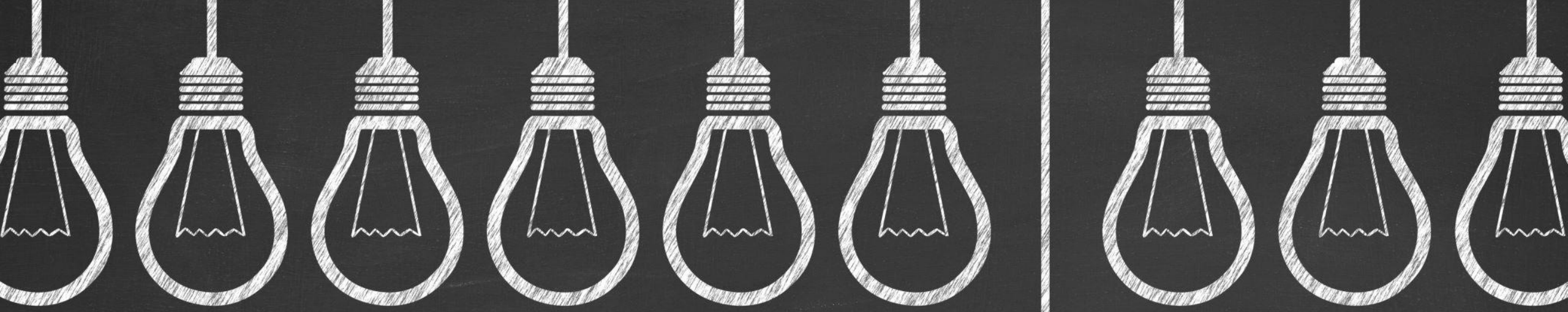


What's Your Story?

You are not just what your clothes say.

You are also **telling a story** about yourself with your **words**, your **action**, and your **style**.





Conclusion

What have we learned today?

A close-up photograph of several pink orchids with white and pink petals, set against a solid teal background. The flowers are in various stages of bloom, with some showing the intricate details of the center.

Thank you for your time!

Any questions?



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